



Harmer, Simon

South Africa M · Off Spin · **vs left-handers**

RSA

BALLS 1,005	WICKETS 28	ECONOMY 2.4	BOWLING AVG 14.5
STRIKE RATE 35.9	AVG SPEED 84.6 kph P99 93.9	AVG LENGTH 4.42 m Short 0%	ROUND THE WKT 99% LHB 99% · RHB 42%

Scouting Summary

COMMON THEMES

- Off Spin, averaging 84.6 kph (up to 93.9).
- Typical length is **4-5m** (their good length); median 4.4 m.
- Stock ball is **full on the stumps, turning away, drifting in, hitting the stumps** (32% of deliveries).
- Goes round the wicket 99% of the time against left-handers.
- Turns it 4.7° on average; 37% of balls turn ≥5°.

BIGGEST THREATS

- Most dangerous length is **Good Length** (10 wkts, 3.7% adjusted strike).
- Danger pitching line: **4th stump** (round the wicket).
- Takes 29% of wickets pitching **full in the 4th-stump channel**, round the wicket.
- Beats the bat 9.0% of tracked balls (false-shot 25.6%).
- Most likely to dismiss you **caught** (57% of wickets).
- 56% of catches are behind the wicket (keeper / slips / gully); most often to slip: 1st, slip: 2nd, point: backward.
- Very repeatable with his length — using your feet to change his length is more effective than waiting for a loose ball.

AREAS TO EXPLOIT

- Concedes most runs pitching **full on the stumps** (25% of runs).
- Away from good length, the wicket threat drops off — look to score in the less-productive lengths.
- Most of his runs leak through the leg side (39%) — his main scoring release.
- Cash in when he goes **full outside off** (economy 3.3, beats the bat only 26%).

Bowling Fingerprint

Release height
P96



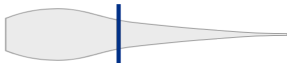
2.29 m · vs right-arm spin

Crease width
P72



84 cm · vs right-arm spin

Crease variation
P74



±24 cm · vs right-arm spin

Turn
P93



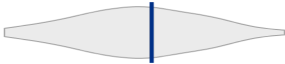
4.8° · vs spin bowlers

Drift
P82



2.0° · vs spin bowlers

Bounce
P57



4.4° · vs spin bowlers

Repeatability
P94



±0.8 m · vs spin bowlers

Percentile within same-type peers (grey = the peer distribution, line = this bowler). Release/crease vs hand × pace/spin; movement/speed/repeatability vs pace/spin. Release & speed are modern-era (2017+ / partial). **Crease variation** = how much he moves his release point sideways across the crease from ball to ball (within his main angle): a high percentile = he varies where he lets the ball go a lot, a low percentile = he releases from the same spot every ball. **Repeatability** = length consistency over his stock-length band (2–11 m, so deliberate yorkers and bouncers don't count as poor control): a high percentile = tighter, more metronomic lengths than peers; a low percentile = he varies his length more. A marker at the very edge = he sits beyond the typical peer range on that trait.

He's around his career level lately (avg 15 last 5 vs 19 career).

Window	Balls	Wkts	Avg	Econ	SR	False%	Avg speed	Avg length
Last 5 Tests	1,237	35	15.3	2.60	35.3	26%	85	4.45 m
Career	1,986	49	18.6	2.75	40.5	20%	84	4.45 m

Threat Profile [▶ watch wickets](#)

BEATEN %
9.0%
n=1,005

FALSE-SHOT %
25.6%
beaten + edges

AVG TURN
4.7°
37% ≥5°

AVG DRIFT
2.2°
in-air

How he gets you out	His %	Base	Index
Caught	57%	59%	0.97×
LBW	25%	20%	1.26×
Bowled	11%	17%	0.63×
Stumped	7%	4%	1.61×

Share of his 28 wickets by type, indexed against the base rate vs the average spin bowler to LHB (men's Tests). **Index** >1 = he does it more than most, <1 = less. Caught is high for everyone — the signal is the over-indexed row.

Catches to: [Slip: 1st 5](#) [Slip: 2nd 2](#) [Point: backward 2](#) [Point: silly 1](#)

[Mid off: regulation 1](#) [Cover: short extra 1](#)

Angle & variations: Uses round the wicket to both (LHB 98% · RHB 42%)

Stock Ball & Ball Types (vs left-handers) [▶ watch stock balls](#)

Stock ball — full on the stumps, turning away, drifting in, hitting the stumps (32% of deliveries, economy 1.97). Minor variations: full in the channel (21%) and full outside off (14%).

Ball type (pitch length × pitching line)	Movement	%	Econ	Wkts	Beaten %
full on the stumps ▶	turning away, drifting in	32%	1.97	8	28%
full in the channel ▶	turning away, drifting in	21%	2.06	8	23%
full outside off ▶	turning away, drifting in	14%	3.30	2	26%
full down the leg side ▶	turning away, drifting in	8%	2.65	0	32%
a good length on the stumps ▶	turning away, drifting in	8%	1.66	3	21%
a good length in the channel ▶	turning away, drifting in	7%	2.91	2	17%

Ball type = pitch-length band × pitching-line region. **Movement** = swing in the air + seam/turn off the pitch, whichever is material, dominant first (ball-tracking, tracked balls only; blank if too few). **Beaten %** = false-shot rate on tracked balls. The stock-ball line above also notes where it passes the stumps.

New ball vs old ball

New ball (≤30 ov) · 410 balls · 14 wkts · econ 2.09

Top ball type	%	Econ	Wkts
full on the stumps	36%	1.15	7
full in the channel	21%	2.21	6
full outside off	11%	2.93	0
full down the leg side	10%	3.00	0

Most lethal: **full 4th stump** (5.3 wkts/100).
How his ball types and threat shift with ball age (split at 30 overs). Empty side = too few balls in that phase.

Old ball (31+ ov) · 595 balls · 14 wkts · econ 2.65

Top ball type	%	Econ	Wkts
full on the stumps	29%	2.66	1
full in the channel	21%	1.95	2
full outside off	16%	3.48	2
a good length on the stumps	9%	1.85	3

Most lethal: **good length Stumps** (3.7 wkts/100).

Danger Zones (vs left-handers) [▶ watch danger balls](#)

WICKETS — WHERE MOST CAME FROM
Full in the 4th-stump channel
29% of mapped wickets (8 of 28)

RUNS — WHERE MOST CONCEDED
Full on the stumps
25% of runs (103 of 406)

DANGER LINE
4th stump
10 wkts / 283 balls · 3.4% adj (3.5% raw)

DANGER LENGTH
Good Length
10 wkts / 250 balls · 3.7% adj (4.0% raw)

MOST LETHAL ZONE (BY RATE)
Good Length / 5th stump
3 wkts / 48 balls · 4.1% adj (6.2% raw) · low sample

Most threatening pitching a good length in the 4th-stump channel (10 wkts, 3.7% strike). Most wickets come from full in the 4th-stump channel, while he leaks the most runs full on the stumps.

NEW BALL (≤ 30 OV)

full 4th stump

most lethal cell · 5.3 wkts/100 · danger length full · 14 wkts off 410 balls

OLD BALL (31+ OV)

good length Stumps

most lethal cell · 3.7 wkts/100 · danger length good length · 14 wkts off 595 balls

Match-ups (vs left-handers)

New ball vs old ball

Split	Balls	Wkts	Avg	Econ	SR	False%	Med length
New ball (≤30 ov)	410	14	10.2	2.09	29.3	29%	4.33 m
Old ball (31+ ov)	595	14	18.8	2.65	42.5	23%	4.55 m

Lower average / higher false-shot = the match-up that suits him; higher average = where batters have got on top. Med length = his median pitch length in that split.

By batting position

Split	Balls	Wkts	Avg	Econ	SR	False%	Med length
Top order (1–3)	526	12	17.1	2.34	43.8	25%	4.36 m
Middle (4–7)	316	7	22.6	3.00	45.1	26%	4.58 m
Tail (8–11)	163	9	4.8	1.58	18.1	28%	4.57 m

Scoring Profile (vs left-handers)

42% of his runs come in boundaries — a boundary every 26 balls; most runs go to the leg side (39%); the drive hurts most (16 fours/sixes at 1.8 runs/ball).

BOUNDARY %
42%
runs in 4s/6s

ROTATED %
58%
runs in 1s & 2s

BALLS / BOUNDARY
26

OFF SIDE %
34%
of runs

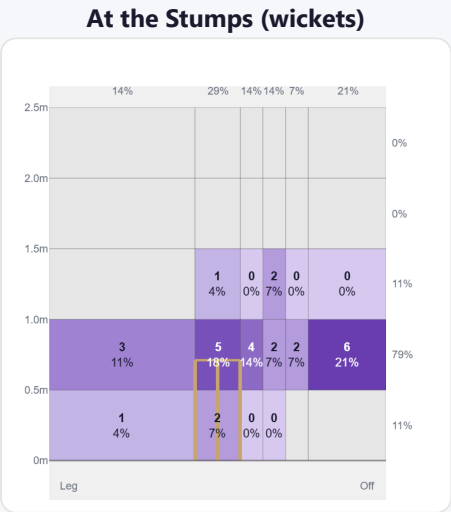
LEG SIDE %
39%
of runs

STRAIGHT %
27%
down the ground

Shot type	Balls	Runs	% runs	4s/6s	Runs/ball
Drive	82	145	38%	16	1.77
Work/Nudge	76	92	24%	1	1.21
Sweep	27	73	19%	12	2.70
Cut	25	49	13%	4	1.96

Direction from ball-tracking (all scoring shots); shot type recorded on 100% of scoring balls (232/232) — groups with <5 balls omitted.

Pitch Maps & Scoring

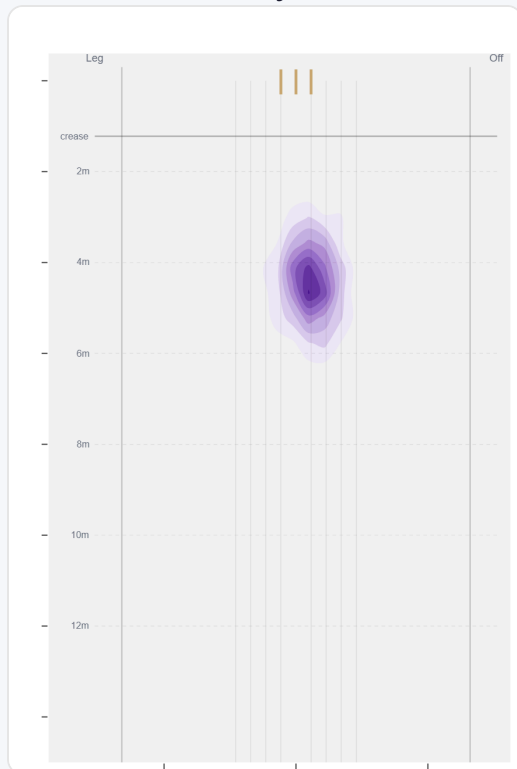


Wicket balls pass the stumps mostly at stumps.



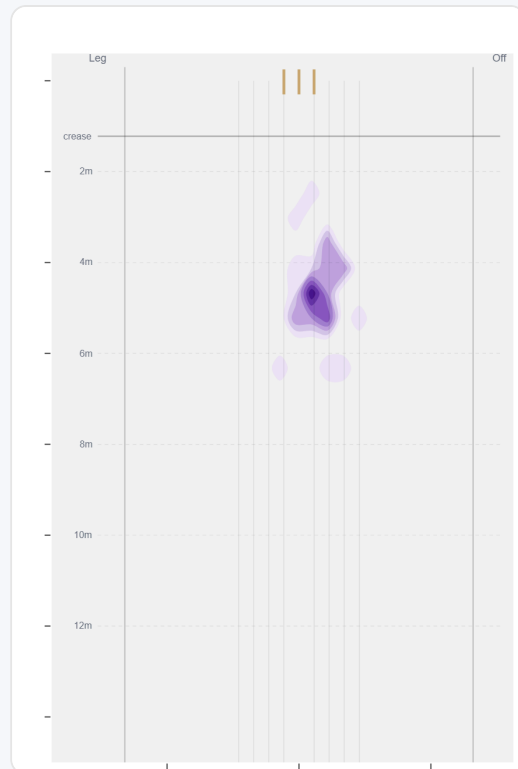
Runs come mostly on the off side (51%).

Where They Pitch It



Pitches it full on the stumps most often (31%); rarely drops short (0%).

Where Wickets Come From

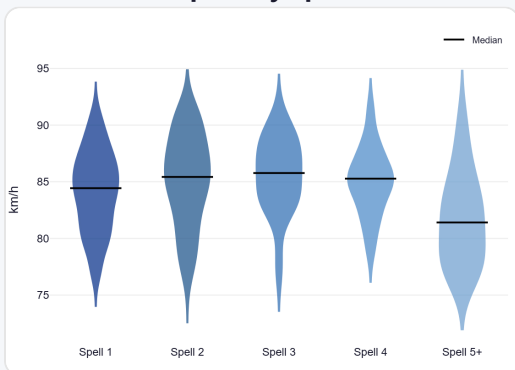


Wickets come mostly from balls pitched full in the 4th-stump channel, but strikes most often pitching in the 4th-stump channel.

Speed & Spells

He holds his pace across spells, is quicker in the 2nd innings, and is as quick on the final day as day one.

Speed by Spell



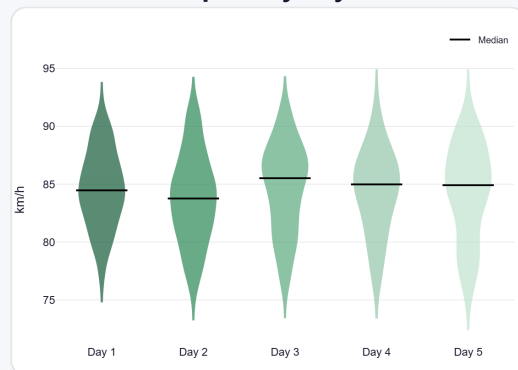
By spell — opening burst vs later spells.

Speed by Innings



1st vs 2nd innings of the match.

Speed by Day



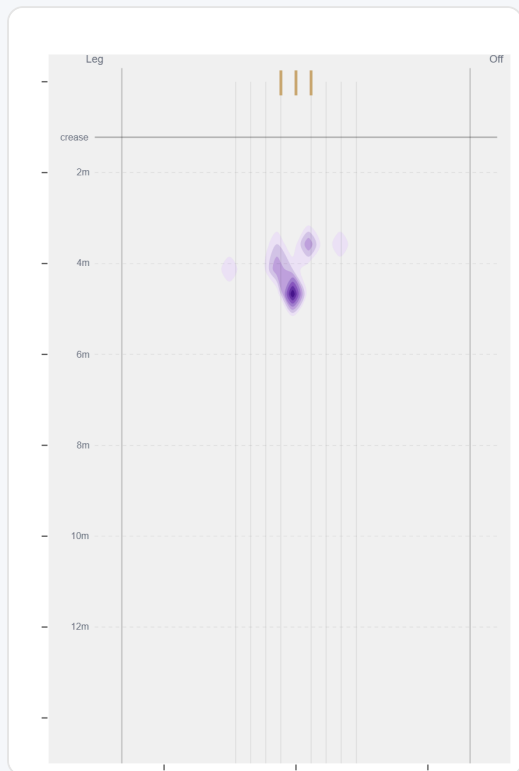
By match day — fatigue across the game.

Over vs Round the Wicket (vs left-handers)

Almost exclusively round the wicket to left-handers (99%, 993 balls); the over the wicket sample (12 balls) is too small to read into.

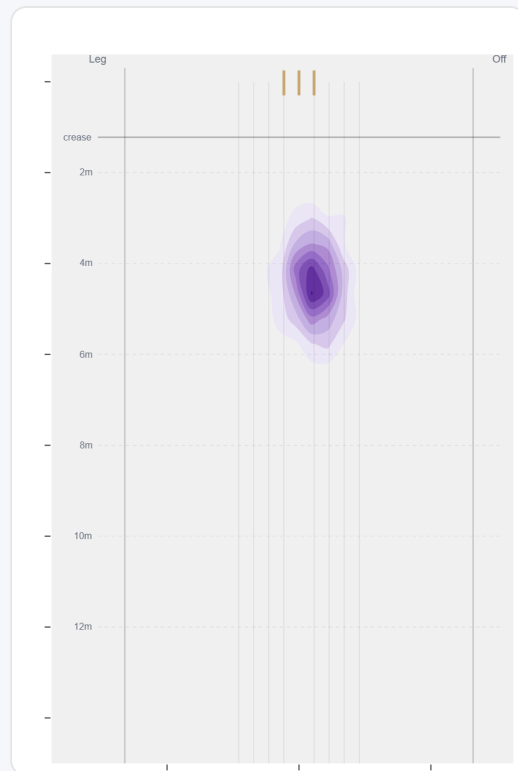
Angle	Balls	Pitch line	Length	Short %	Econ	Wkts	Bdry %
Over	12 (1%)	Stumps	—	—	1.00	0	0%
Round	993 (99%)	Stumps	4.4 m	0%	2.44	28	42%

Over the Wicket



Over the wicket — only 12 balls to left-handers, too few to read into.

Round the Wicket



Where he pitches it from round the wicket (993 balls).

Sequencing & Over Construction

Relentlessly consistent — repeats his length ball after ball (length spread ± 0.9 m; more repeatable than 94% of spin bowlers); holds a steady length right through the over; and holds the same crease position through the over.

Across 38 dismissals, his wicket ball is close in length and pace to the delivery before it — he builds pressure with repetition, not a big change-up.

Ball in over	Median length	Short %	Econ	Wkt %
Ball 1	4.4 m	0%	2.98	3.6%
Ball 2	4.4 m	0%	2.32	4.2%
Ball 3	4.3 m	0%	1.92	5.9%
Ball 4	4.4 m	0%	3.02	1.8%
Ball 5	4.4 m	0%	2.16	0.0%
Ball 6	4.6 m	0%	2.14	1.2%

Length spread = std-dev of pitch length (smaller = more repeatable). The table shows how his length, scoring and wicket rate shift across the six balls of an over. Set-up lines compare each ball with the previous delivery in the same over (career, all batters).

Release Point & Crease Use

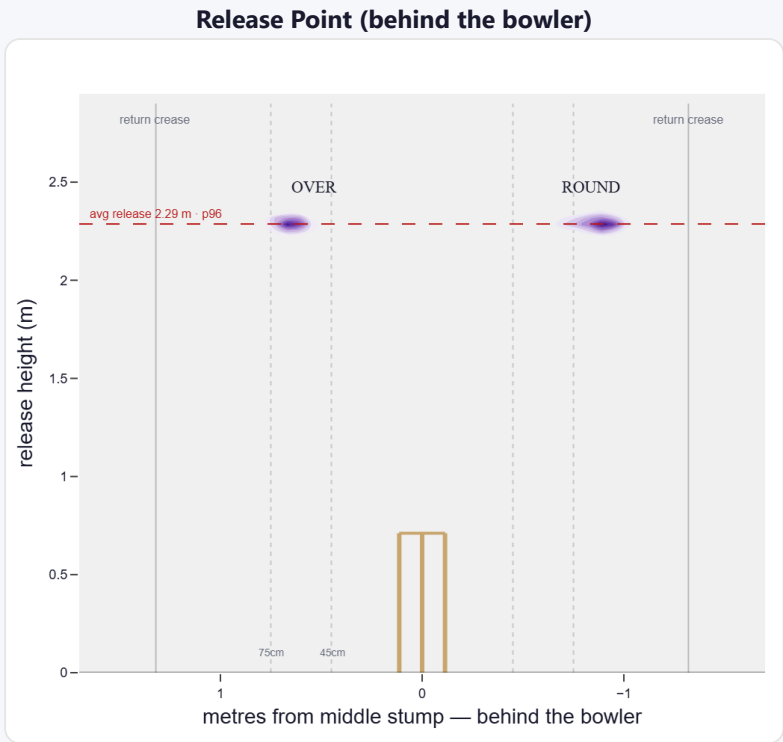
A high release point (taller than 96% of right-arm spin); releases wide of the stumps (84 cm out, wider than 72% of right-arm spin); varies his spot on the crease a lot (more than 74% of right-arm spin). Comes wider round the wicket (53 cm over vs 84 cm round).

Crease position	% balls	Balls	Econ	Wkts	Avg	SR
Standard (45–75)	37%	736	3.02	13	28.5	57
Wide (>75cm)	62%	1,240	2.62	36	15.0	34

How he goes when he releases tight / standard / wide of the middle stump (all release-tracked balls).

Angle	Balls	Tight	Standard	Wide
Over the wicket	29%	1%	94%	5%
Round the wicket	71%	0%	14%	86%

His crease-position mix, split by over vs round. Release data is modern-era (2017+); percentiles vs same hand + type.



Where he lets the ball go — lateral position × height (purple density). Over and round labelled; dotted lines mark tight/standard/wide and the return creases.

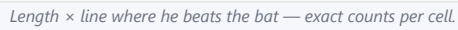
Movement (vs the average spin bowler · vs left-handers)

A big turner of the ball; gets sharp drift in the air.

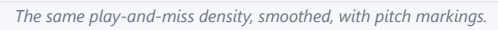
Generates well above avg turn and well above avg drift for a spin bowler; turns it away more to left-hand batters (92%).

Percentile vs all Test spin bowlers; direction is which way it moves to this batter. Bounce = extra bounce vs expected.

Movement	Avg	vs average	Direction (vs left-handers)
Drift	2.04°	81st pct (well above avg)	8% away / 92% in
Turn	4.81°	92nd pct (well above avg)	92% away / 8% in
Bounce	4.4°	57th pct (about average)	—



Beats the bat most at **Full / Stumps** (40% of play-and-misses). Overall he beats the bat 9.0% of tracked balls (false-shot 25.6%, n=1,005).



Harmer, Simon · bowling scout